

volcanic rock, or writing up my research, or attending a conference, or visiting schools and science fairs.

Q: Have you written any books or appeared on television?

A: I've been on television a few times, and sometimes I work as an adviser on programmes. I'm writing a book at the moment.

Q: What sort of equipment do you use?

A: At volcanic sites, I also use ultraviolet and infrared spectrometers to measure volcanic gases. I also use a lot of specialized software for mapping, and for analyzing the information that I gather from my research. In the laboratory, I use special instruments to measure the compositions of volcanic rocks.



Teamwork is important.

Q: How accurate is it possible to be when predicting an earthquake or a volcanic eruption?

A: It varies quite a lot. Earthquakes cannot be predicted, but we can identify areas that are at more risk than others.

For volcanoes, there are often signs that an eruption is likely to happen.

However, we may not pick them up, as many volcanoes are not monitored closely, and signs that a volcano is about to become active can be hard to spot. But there have been opportunities to warn people and clear areas successfully before an eruption, such as with Mount Merapi in Indonesia in 2010.

Q: Is your job ever dangerous?

A: It can be! Volcanoes sometimes surprise you, and there have been times when I have had to move very quickly because of a sudden, unexpected increase in volcanic activity.

Q: What do you love most about your work?

A: I love my research. I love working with volcanologists and studying ways that people deal with the problems of living near a volcano. There's a lot to be learned, and it is exciting and satisfying to be involved in protecting a place from serious damage, or even destruction.

Q: What has been your most exciting experience so far?

A: I monitored the 2014–15 Holuhraun eruptions in Iceland. That was fantastic! We were in the Icelandic highlands, which are spectacular. It was the largest eruption there since 1783–84, so it was interesting scientifically, too.



Through a spectrometer